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[Continued on next page]

(54) Title: INNOVATION MANAGEMENT

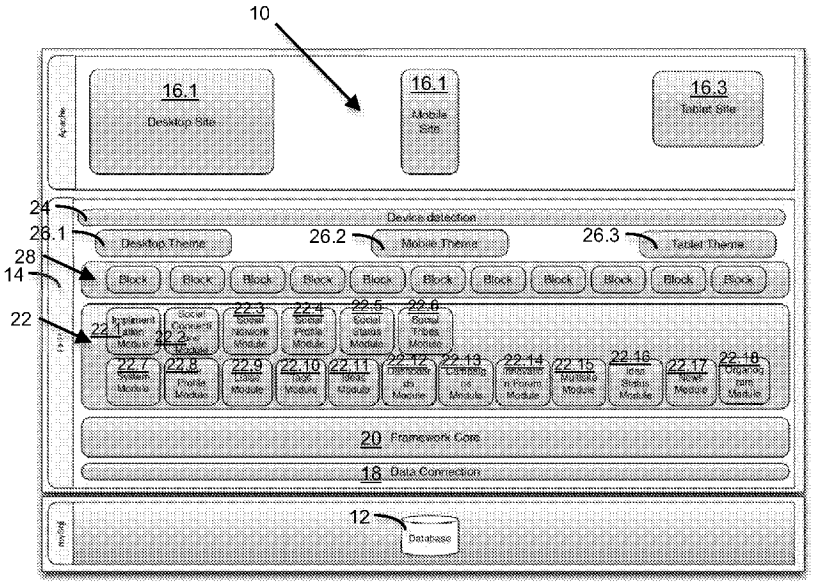

Fig. 1

(57) Abstract: An innovation management system, which includes a database of networked members, each of the networked members being associated with a pre-defined user profile, a user interface operable to receive inputs from a member and to display selected outputs to a member, a campaigns module onto which campaigns can be defined, a campaign being defined as a call to networked members to submit ideas for a particular context defined by the campaign, and an ideas module onto which ideas can be loaded, the ideas selectively being associated with a pre-defined campaign.

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INTERNATIONAL SEARCH REPORT

International application No.
PCT/IB 13/59905

A. CLASSIFICATION OF SUBJECT MATTER
IPC(8) - G06Q 99/00 (2014.01)
USPC - 705/319
According to International Patent Classification (IPC) or to both national classification and IPC

B. FIELDS SEARCHED

Minimum documentation searched (classification system followed by classification symbols)
IPC(8): G06Q 99/00 (2014.01)
USPC: 705/319

Documentation searched other than minimum documentation to the extent that such documents are included in the fields searched
IPC(8): G06Q 99/00 (2014.01)
USPC: 705/1.1, 319 (keyword limited; terms below)

Electronic data base consulted during the international search (name of data base and, where practicable, search terms used)
PatBase; Google(Web); Search terms used: innovation management ideas submit members participants social network group exchange share community collaborate tribe user profile campaign dashboard detect desktop mobile site cluster map visualization graphic score rank vote sentiment

C. DOCUMENTS CONSIDERED TO BE RELEVANT

Category*	Citation of document, with indication, where appropriate, of the relevant passages	Relevant to claim No.
Y	US 2009/0265430 A1 (Bechtel et al.) 22 October 2009 (22.10.2009), entire document especially Fig. 4, 8, 9, 16, 20-23; para [0040]-[0050], [0060], [0107], [0121]-[0124], [0140]-[0151], [0158]-[0169]	1-65
Y	US 2009/0055476 A1 (Markus et al.) 26 February 2009 (26.02.2009), entire document especially para [0049], [0050], [0107]-[0109], [0137], [0153], [0425]	1-65
Y	US 2011/0191372 A1 (Kaushansky et al.) 04 August 2011 (04.08.2011), entire document especially para [0013], [0066], [0072], [0073]	3, 35, 36
Y	US 2012/0129145 A1 (Miller et al.) 24 May 2012 (24.05.2012), Fig. 8A, 8E; para [0036], [0136], [0194], [0203], [0210], [0232], [0233], [0246], [0280], [0281]	26, 32, 59-61, 65

☐ Further documents are listed in the continuation of Box C. ☐

* Special categories of cited documents:
"A" document defining the general state of the art which is not considered to be of particular relevance
"E" earlier application or patent but published on or after the international filing date
"L" document which may throw doubts on priority claim(s) or which is cited to establish the publication date of another citation or other special reason (as specified)
"O" document referring to an oral disclosure, use, exhibition or other means
"P" document published prior to the international filing date but later than the priority date claimed
"T" later document published after the international filing date or priority date and not in conflict with the application but cited to understand the principle or theory underlying the invention
"X" document of particular relevance; the claimed invention cannot be considered novel or cannot be considered to involve an inventive step when the document is taken alone
"Y" document of particular relevance; the claimed invention cannot be considered to involve an inventive step when the document is combined with one or more other such documents, such combination being obvious to a person skilled in the art
"&" document member of the same patent family

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INTERNATIONAL SEARCH REPORT

International application No.
PCT/IB 13/59905

Box No. II Observations where certain claims were found unsearchable (Continuation of item 2 of first sheet)

This international search report has not been established in respect of certain claims under Article 17(2)(a) for the following reasons:

1. ☐ Claims Nos.:
because they relate to subject matter not required to be searched by this Authority, namely:

2. ☐ Claims Nos.:
because they relate to parts of the international application that do not comply with the prescribed requirements to such an extent that no meaningful international search can be carried out, specifically:

3. ☐ Claims Nos.:
because they are dependent claims and are not drafted in accordance with the second and third sentences of Rule 6.4(a).

Box No. III Observations where unity of invention is lacking (Continuation of item 3 of first sheet)

This International Searching Authority found multiple inventions in this international application, as follows:

--- See extra sheet ---

1. ☐ As all required additional search fees were timely paid by the applicant, this international search report covers all searchable claims.

2. ☐ As all searchable claims could be searched without effort justifying additional fees, this Authority did not invite payment of additional fees.

3. ☐ As only some of the required additional search fees were timely paid by the applicant, this international search report covers only those claims for which fees were paid, specifically claims Nos.:

4. ☒ No required additional search fees were timely paid by the applicant. Consequently, this international search report is restricted to the invention first mentioned in the claims; it is covered by claims Nos.:
1-65

Remark on Protest

☐ The additional search fees were accompanied by the applicant's protest and, where applicable, the payment of a protest fee.

☐ The additional search fees were accompanied by the applicant's protest but the applicable protest fee was not paid within the time limit specified in the invitation.

☐ No protest accompanied the payment of additional search fees.

Continuation of Box No. III: Observations where unity of invention is lacking (Continuation of item 3 of first sheet)

Reasons for Lack of Unity of Invention:

This application contains the following inventions or groups of inventions that are not so linked as to form a single general inventive concept under PCT Rule 13.1. In order for all inventions to be searched, the appropriate additional search fees must be paid.

Group I: Claims 1-65 directed to an innovation management system/method of managing innovation, which includes a database of networked members, each of the networked members being associated with a pre-defined user profile, a user interface operable to receive inputs from a member and to display selected outputs to a member, a campaigns module onto which campaigns can be defined, a campaign being defined as a call to networked members to submit ideas for a particular context defined by the campaign, an ideas module onto which ideas can be loaded, the ideas selectively being associated with a pre-defined campaign.

Group II: Claims 66-67 directed to a method of mapping networked members to ideas, the method including plotting on a two dimensional plane markers indicative of networked members and associated ideas, the markers of members and ideas initially being distributed equally over the two dimensional plane, linking markers of members that are networked together with each other by drawing vectors between the markers, linking markers of ideas that are associated with members together with each other by drawing vectors between the markers of members and of associated ideas, minimizing the length of the vectors by moving the markers of networked members and associated ideas on the two-dimensional plane so as to create a clustering of members and ideas around the most densely networked members and ideas.

The inventions listed as Groups I-II do not relate to a single general inventive concept under PCT Rule 13.1 because, under PCT Rule 13.2, they lack the same or corresponding special technical features for the following reasons:

The special technical feature of the Group I invention is directed to an innovation management system/method of managing innovation, which includes a database of networked members each associated with a pre-defined user profile, a campaigns module onto which campaigns can be defined, a campaign being defined as a call to networked members to submit ideas for a particular context defined by the campaign, an ideas module onto which ideas can be loaded, the ideas selectively being associated with a pre-defined campaign.

The special technical feature of the Group II invention is directed to a method of mapping networked members to ideas, the method including plotting on a two dimensional plane markers indicative of networked members and associated ideas, the markers of members and ideas initially being distributed equally over the two dimensional plane, linking markers of members that are networked together with each other by drawing vectors between the markers, linking markers of ideas that are associated with members together with each other by drawing vectors between the markers of members and of associated ideas, minimizing the length of the vectors by moving the markers of networked members and associated ideas on the two-dimensional plane so as to create a clustering of members and ideas around the most densely networked members and ideas.

The only common technical feature shared by the above groups is linking networked members to ideas.

The common technical feature does not represent an improvement over the prior art of US 2007/0271272 A1 to McGuire et al. (Published 22 November 2007) that teaches linking networked members to ideas in para [0059]-[0060] (provides the social-network or personal-communication-network members with who in their network has access, knowledge, or experience with that information relating to the search. For example, if a physician were to type in "leukemia," the social search engine would produce a list of physicians who specialize in leukemia--either researchers who study the disease, oncologists or hematologists who treat it, or physicians who have experience with medications or chemotherapy. In other words, the physician does not obtain a list of "specially ranked" websites by anonymous authors, but actually receives the names and profiles of other physicians (to whom they are linked) that may be considered experts on the topic and how the searcher is connected to the physicians who possess the information), para [0137](personal-communication-network members to analyze personal-communication-network data to obtain search results such as: degrees (the number of direct connections or first-degree contacts a personal-communication-network member has), betweenness (represents a bridge between two cliques or clusters in a person communication network), closeness (a measurement of how close a person is to everyone else in the network), boundary spanners (have access to ideas and information flowing in other clusters--innovators), peripheral players (often connected to networks that are not currently mapped), structural equivalence (determine which people play similar roles in the network), cluster analysis (find cliques and other densely connected clusters)) and prior-art of US 2012/0246087 A1 to Talati et al. (Published 27 September 2012) that teaches linking networked members to ideas in Abstract (establishing an exclusive network of Strong Tie connections which is then used to make referenceable connections between members for various personal and business benefits. In real life, everyone has close relationships with a few people who provide emotional support to the member and also influence member's purchase as well other important decisions. These are Strong Tie connections. As the network is limited to only Strong Tie connections, it enables various purpose driven applications without any member having direct access to other member data. Applications include Connect, Find Match, Find Person, Group Buy and Job Search. For example, through this network, members can make referenceable connections with other members who are important for personal and business reasons and who they do not know personally but are known to their Strong Tie connections or Strong Ties of Strong Ties and so on) and para [0039]-[0040] (intelligent integration of concepts of "Social Networks", "Connection Maps" and `Search Engines". They use social networking concept to establish multilevel networking connections),.

As the above technical feature of linking networked members to ideas as taught by McGuire et al and/or Talati et al. was known, this cannot be considered a special technical feature that would otherwise unify the groups.

Therefore, the inventions of Groups I-II lack unity of invention under PCT Rule 13 because they do not share a same or corresponding special technical feature.